Buying became trackable, auditable, faster, and smarter.

A procurement operating model that moved purchasing out of email and credit cards into governed workflows, then embedded AI-assisted decision support across the buying lifecycle.

HOW TO READ THIS

01 – 03

For leaders: the problem, what I built, and what it delivered.

A1 – A3

For technical teams: how it works, with illustrative output.

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The organization was scaling fast while purchasing still ran on email, credit cards, and individual follow-up

Procurement is where a need becomes a controlled purchase. Without structure, nobody can see what is being bought or why, purchases may not hold up in review, and every buyer works from their own experience.

WHAT I INHERITED

No intake process	Requests arrived by email and credit card
No spend visibility	No vendor governance or view of spend by category
Manual evidence	Paper-driven records, with audit support rebuilt after the fact
Uneven decisions	Quality depended on the individual buyer's experience

WHY IT MATTERS TO LEADERSHIP

Risk

Purchases made without controls are findings waiting to happen.

Cost

Spend you can't see can't be managed or negotiated.

Speed

Manual routing and follow-up slow down every purchase.

I built it in stages, adding the structure each stage required

PHASE	Before	Control	Scale	Intelligence
Need and request	No formal intake	Standardized intake form	Workflow-based requests	Requirement translation, coding
Sourcing	No documented research	Not yet structured	Supplier network, competitive bidding	Market research, supplier comparison
Analysis and negotiation	No structured analysis	Not yet structured	Standard templates	Price analysis, negotiation prep
Buying and administration	Credit card spend, no process	Approval workflow and audit evidence	Catalogs, receiving, reconciliation	Predictive and compliance analysis
The path I led	STARTING POINT Email, cards, and individual follow-up	DELIVERED Workflow-driven intake, approvals	DELIVERED One platform to buy, receive, reconcile	TOOLS BUILT Guided research and negotiation prep

THE DESIGN PRINCIPLES

Build for the next stage

Control first, then scale, then intelligence, each when the work was ready for it.

Evidence in the workflow

Every step records what a review will ask for, so nothing is rebuilt later.

Judgment stays with buyers

AI prepares research, pricing, and documentation. People make the decision.

Procurement went from a routine compliance function to a strategic driver of speed and margin

75% faster cycles

Procurement cycle time cut by three quarters

1K+ micropurchases

Processed through catalogs in the first year

Millions in managed spend

Governed and visible in the first operating year

Approved in one review

Purchasing and property systems approved together

What this means for your organization

I balance structure and speed: the controls a function needs to stay compliant, built so the work moves faster instead of slower.

The same approach is described in general terms in **How I Work**.

AI supports every stage of buying without replacing the buyer's judgment

BUYING STAGE	AI SUPPORT	HOW IT IS GOVERNED
Need and request	Requirement translation, commodity coding, and standardized intake	Intake form standards
Sourcing	Market research, commercial item determination, and supplier comparison	Source-linked guidance
Analysis and negotiation	Price analysis, negotiation preparation, and rationale drafting	Policy-grounded outputs
Buying and administration	Workflow governance, reconciliation, receiving coordination, and reporting	Audit-traceable workflow

The system catches risk automatically and leaves the judgment calls to buyers, so their time goes to thinking and negotiating instead of checking boxes.

A buyer asks about a license purchase and gets the questions and targets to negotiate with

THE REQUEST

"A program needs 75 user licenses. What do I need to do next?"

Illustrative example

WHAT I BUILD

Buyers start with better questions and a clear negotiating position.

GUIDED QUESTIONS

Internal requirements
Full access, or read-only?
Named or concurrent licenses?

Vendor questions
Can unused licenses be reassigned monthly?
What is the renewal cap?

Trade-offs to ask for
Locked pricing, reassignment, onboarding licenses

Draft for human review

SAMPLE OUTPUT

Negotiation targets

Scenario	Discount	Index
List price	0%	100
Acceptable	20%	80
Target	**30%**	**70**
Stretch	35%	65

Index: list price = 100

Aim for Target with SSO and a renewal cap included.

Targets are shown as an index rather than dollars. The buyer gets a starting position and the questions to test it; the negotiation and the decision stay with them.

Market research shows its gaps instead of filling them in

THE REQUEST

"We need about 75 rugged laptops in 60 days. What does the market offer?"

Illustrative example

WHAT I BUILD

Research that surfaces gaps instead of filling them in.

RESEARCH PLAN

1 Clarify the requirement
Missing specs, risks, timing

2 Map public sources
Registrations, awards, pricing

3 Flag compliance
Size status, trade rules

Hand back to the contracting officer when data can't be verified.

SAMPLE OUTPUT

Draft for human review

Vendor landscape

Vendor	Size	History
Vendor A	Small	Yes
Vendor B	Large	Yes
Vendor C	Small	*Not found*

Gap shown, not filled
Vendor C award history needs verification in an authoritative source.

Public sources are mapped before anything is concluded. When data can't be verified, the gap is labeled and the decision goes back to the contracting officer.

CASE BRIEF · PROCUREMENT

Better inputs. Better analysis. Better negotiations. Better execution.

This is what it looks like when buying becomes a process people can follow, track, audit, and improve.

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